

Word family: **bear / bears / bore / borne / born / bearing / bearer / bearable / unbearable / bearish**

Base word: bear

Present: bear, bears

Past: bore

Past participle: borne / born

ing: bearing

Related forms: bearer, bearable, unbearable, unbearably, bearish

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Other patrons then **bear the consequences**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **bear** means **to suffer, accept, or carry the negative effects or consequences of something**.

The other restaurant customers did not create the problem, but they have to experience its effects —such as difficulty finding seats.

繁體中文: **承受；承擔；忍受某件事所帶來的後果、代價或負擔**

中文翻譯: **

> “Other patrons then **bear the consequences**.”

「其他顧客便要**承受後果**。」

Here:

bear the consequences = 承受 / 承擔某件事情造成的後果

1. **bear = large heavy mammal (動物) — 熊**

This is the completely separate noun sense.

Practice 1

> “We saw a **bear** near the river.”

「我們在河邊看見一隻**熊**。」

Practice 2

> “Brown **bears** can be extremely powerful.”

「棕**熊**可以非常強壯。」

Common compounds:

* brown bear

* polar bear

* black bear

* teddy bear

This noun is semantically independent of most verb uses.

2. **bear** = carry something, especially something heavy or important (攜帶) — 搬 ; 負載 ; 攜帶

This is the old central physical verb sense.

Practice 3

> “The workers **bore** heavy loads up the hill.”

「工人把沉重的貨物**搬上** / 背上**山坡**。」

Practice 4

> “They came **bearing** gifts.”

「他們帶着禮物而來。」

bear = 攜帶、搬運或負荷某物

Today this sounds more formal or literary than ordinary **carry** in many contexts.

3. **bear** = support or carry weight (支撐) — 承受重量 ; 支撐

A structure or object can **bear** a load.

Practice 5

> “The bridge can ****bear**** the weight of several trucks.”

「這座橋可以****承受****數輛貨車的重量。」

Practice 6

> “These columns ****bear**** most of the roof’s weight.”

「這些柱子****支撐****着屋頂大部分重量。」

****bear weight/load = 承受或支撐施加在某物上的重量 / 負荷****

Common technical constructions:

- * load-bearing wall
- * weight-bearing structure
- * bearing capacity

This remains closely connected to physical carrying.

4. ****bear = endure or tolerate something unpleasant (忍受) — 忍受 ; 承受****

A major everyday figurative sense.

Practice 7

> “I can’t ****bear**** the noise.”

「我****受不了****這種噪音。」

Practice 8

> “She could hardly ****bear**** the pain.”

「她幾乎無法****忍受****那種痛楚。」

Practice 9

> “I can’t ****bear**** to watch.”

「我****不忍心 / 受不了****看下去。」

****bear = 面對令人痛苦、不舒服或討厭的事情而忍受下去****

Very common:

- * can't bear something
- * can't bear doing something
- * can't bear to do something
- * bear the pain
- * bear the heat

5. **bear = carry/suffer a burden, cost, loss, consequence, responsibility, etc. (負擔) — 承擔 ; 承受**

This is the **exact branch in your passage**.

Practice 10 — Original

> “Other patrons then **bear the consequences**.”

「其他顧客便要**承受後果**。」

Practice 11

> “Businesses should not have to **bear** all the additional costs.”

「企業不應被迫**承擔**所有額外成本。」

Practice 12

> “The family had to **bear** the financial burden.”

「這個家庭不得不**承受**經濟負擔。」

Common:

- * bear the consequences
- * bear the cost
- * bear the burden
- * bear the loss
- * bear the risk
- * bear responsibility
- * bear the blame

The underlying metaphor is:

> ****a difficult responsibility/cost is a heavy object that someone has to carry****

6. ****bear responsibility / blame = be responsible for something (責任) — 承擔責任 ; 負責****

Practice 13

> “The company must ****bear responsibility**** for the mistake.”

「公司必須為這個錯誤****承擔責任****。」

Practice 14

> “One person should not ****bear all the blame****.”

「不應由一個人****承擔所有責任 / 指責****。」

For strict counting, I would keep this under Meaning 5 rather than create another unrelated core meaning.

7. ****bear the burden of proof (法律) — 承擔舉證責任****

A particularly important legal construction:

> ****bear the burden of proof****

= ****負有舉證責任****

Practice 15

> “The prosecution normally ****bears the burden of proof**** in a criminal trial.”

「刑事審訊中，控方通常****負有舉證責任****。」

This is the formal responsibility branch.

8. ****bear = produce fruit, flowers, crops, etc. (植物) — 結 ; 長出 ; 產生****

Plants and trees can ****bear**** fruit.

Practice 16

> “The tree **bears** fruit every summer.”

「這棵樹每年夏天都會**結果**。」

Practice 17

> “The plants have begun to **bear** flowers.”

「這些植物已開始**開花 / 長出花朵**。」

bear = 生長並產生果實、花朵或農作物

This is a major distinct sense.

9. **bear fruit** = produce successful results (比喻) — 取得成果 ; 見效

The plant sense produces an extremely common metaphor.

Practice 18

> “Their efforts finally **bore** fruit.”

「他們的努力終於**取得成果**。」

Practice 19

> “The negotiations are beginning to **bear** fruit.”

「談判開始**見到成果**。」

bear fruit = 努力、計劃、研究等開始產生有價值的結果

This is a fixed figurative extension of Meaning 8.

10. **bear** = give birth to a child / produce offspring (生育) — 生下 ; 生育

Formal/literary compared with ordinary **give birth to**.

Practice 20

> “She **bore** three children.”

「她**生了**三個孩子。」

Practice 21

> “The queen **bore** an heir.”

「王后**誕下**了一名繼承人。」

bear a child = 懷孕並生下孩子

This is a distinct major sense.

Crucial grammar: **born vs borne**

This is one of the most important irregular-form distinctions in English.

born

Use **born** for birth, especially:

> **be born**

Practice 22

> “She was **born** in 2005.”

「她於 2005 年**出生**。」

Not:

> “She was borne in 2005.” ❌

for ordinary birth.

borne

Use **borne** as the past participle for almost all other meanings of **bear**:

> costs borne by the company

> responsibility borne by taxpayers

> disease borne by mosquitoes

Practice 23

> “The cost was **borne** by the restaurant.”

「這筆成本由餐廳**承擔**。」

Practice 24

> “The structure has **borne** the weight for decades.”

「這個結構已經**承受**該重量數十年。」

Even in the birth sense, active formal English can use:

> “She has **borne** three children.”

But:

> “Her children were **born** in Hong Kong.”

So the useful rule is:

be born = 出生

borne = bear 的一般過去分詞

11. **bear** = produce/yield money, interest, or another return (金融) — 產生；帶來

Formal financial English uses **bear** for something that yields a return.

Practice 25

> “The account **bears** interest.”

「這個帳戶會**產生利息 / 計息**。」

Common:

* interest-bearing account

* interest-bearing debt

* bond bearing interest

This derives naturally from:

> tree bears fruit → asset bears financial return.

For core counting, I would place it under the **produce/yield** branch.

12. **bear** = have, carry, or display a name, mark, symbol, signature, etc. (帶有) — 帶有 ; 印有 ; 顯示

A very important formal sense.

Practice 26

> “The document **bears** his signature.”

「這份文件**有 / 載有**他的簽名。」

Practice 27

> “The building **bears** the date 1890.”

「這棟建築物上**刻有 / 標有** 1890 年。」

Practice 28

> “The shield **bears** a lion.”

「盾牌上**有 / 繪有**一隻獅子。」

bear = 某物本身具有、顯示或載有某個名稱、標誌、文字、痕跡等

Common:

- * bear a name
- * bear a mark
- * bear a signature
- * bear a date
- * bear a symbol
- * bear scars

13. **bear** = possess/show a quality, resemblance, relation, etc. (具有) — 具有 ; 呈現 ; 與.....相似 / 相關

Practice 29

> “The two cases **bear** a strong resemblance to each other.”

「這兩宗個案**非常相似**。」

Practice 30

> “His description **bears little relation** to what actually happened.”

「他的描述與實際情況**幾乎沒有關係**。」

Practice 31

> “The results **bear** some similarity to earlier findings.”

「這些結果與早期研究結果**有些相似**。」

bear + abstract relationship/quality = 具有或呈現某種關係、相似性或特徵

Common:

- * bear resemblance to
- * bear relation to
- * bear similarity to
- * bear no connection to

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 12 as:

> **carry/show/possess a feature or relationship**

14. **bear = show traces, signs, scars, evidence, etc. (痕跡) — 留有 ; 帶有**

Practice 32

> “The walls still **bear** the scars of the fire.”

「牆壁仍然**留有**火災造成的痕跡。」

Practice 33

> “The object **bears** signs of heavy use.”

「這件物品**帶有**大量使用過的痕跡。」

Again, this belongs to the “carry/display” branch.

15. **bear witness = testify / provide evidence (正式) — 作證 ; 證明**

An important fixed expression.

Practice 34

> “Several people **bore witness** to the event.”

「幾個人為該事件**作證**。」

It can also be figurative:

> “The ruins bear witness to the city’s long history.”

「這些遺跡**見證 / 證明**這座城市悠久的歷史。」

bear witness to = 作證、證實，或成為某事存在的證據

16. **bear = move or turn in a particular direction (方向) — 向……轉 ; 朝……行進**

A genuinely distinct sense, especially in directions/navigation.

Practice 35

> “At the junction, **bear left**.”

「到路口時，稍微**向左轉 / 靠左走**。」

Practice 36

> “The road **bears** to the right after the bridge.”

「過橋後道路**向右彎**。」

bear left/right = 不一定作九十度急轉，而是逐漸向某方向偏轉 / 行進

This is still common in navigation instructions.

17. **bear = conduct/carry oneself in a particular way (正式) — 舉止；保持某種姿態**

Usually in:

> **bear oneself**

Practice 37

> “She **bore herself** with confidence.”

「她的**舉止**非常自信。」

Practice 38

> “He **bore himself** calmly throughout the interview.”

「整個面試期間，他都保持沉著的**舉止 / 姿態**。」

This is formal and related to the physical idea of carrying oneself.

18. **bear with someone = be patient with them (固定表達) — 耐心等待；包涵**

Practice 39

> “Please **bear with me** for a moment.”

「請**耐心等我一下 / 請稍等**。」

Practice 40

> “Bear with us while we fix the problem.”

「我們處理問題期間，請大家**耐心等待 / 多多包涵**。」

This is extremely common.

It is historically related to **endure/tolerate**, but functions as a fixed expression.

19. **bear in mind = remember and consider (固定表達) — 記住；考慮到**

Practice 41

> “Please **bear in mind** that prices may change.”

「請**記住** / 考慮到**價格**可能會有變。」

bear something in mind = 把某事保留在思考中，作為判斷時需要考慮的因素

This is one of the most useful fixed expressions in formal writing.

20. **bear arms** = carry/use weapons (固定 / 法律歷史) — 攜帶武器；武裝

Practice 42

> “The phrase ‘bear arms’ historically refers to carrying weapons.”

「**bear arms** 這個詞組歷史上指**攜帶武器** / 武裝。」

This belongs to the literal **carry** branch.

Because it can appear in legal or constitutional texts, the exact interpretation can depend heavily on jurisdiction and historical context.

21. **bear** = investor who expects prices to fall (金融名詞) — 看淡市場者；空頭

A major modern noun sense completely separate from the animal in practical financial vocabulary.

Practice 43

> “Market **bears** expect prices to fall.”

「市場上的**看淡者** / 空頭**預期價格**會下跌。」

A **bear** is an investor or trader with a pessimistic view of a market or asset price.

Opposite:

> **bull**

= 看好市場者 / 多頭

22. **bear market** = market with broadly falling prices (金融) — 熊市；下跌市

Practice 44

> “Technology shares entered a **bear market**.”

「科技股進入了**熊市 / 下跌市**。」

bear market = 市場價格在一段時間內廣泛、顯著下跌的市場狀況

Exact technical thresholds can vary by source and context, so the lexical core is simply:

> **a sustained broadly falling market**

Related form: **bearish**

Bearish means expecting prices to fall or indicating downward market sentiment.

Practice 45

> “Investors became increasingly **bearish**.”

「投資者變得越來越**看淡後市**。」

Practice 46

> “The report takes a **bearish** view of the sector.”

「這份報告對該行業持**看淡**看法。」

Opposite:

> **bullish**

= 看好 / 看漲

23. **bear** = difficult or unpleasant thing/person (美式非正式 , 較低優先)

In informal American English:

> “That exam was a **bear**.”

can mean:

> 那場考試非常**難搞 / 艱難**。

A person described as **a bear** can also be rough, bad-tempered, or difficult.

This is genuine but lower-priority informal vocabulary.

24. **bear = a large/heavy hairy gay man (社群用語)**

In modern LGBTQ+ community vocabulary, **bear** can refer to a typically larger, hairy gay or bisexual man associated with the “bear” subculture.

繁體中文：通常可按語境解釋為 熊族 / 熊系男同志

This is a genuine modern community-specific noun sense, but not part of the general learner core.

Related form: **bearable**

Bearable means possible to tolerate.

Practice 47

> “The heat became more **bearable** in the evening.”

「到了晚上，炎熱變得比較**可以忍受**。」

bearable = 雖然不舒服，但仍然能忍受的

Related form: **unbearable**

Much more common than **bearable**.

Practice 48

> “The pain was **unbearable**.”

「疼痛**難以忍受**。」

Practice 49

> “The room became unbearably hot.”

「房間熱得**令人難以忍受**。」

unbearable = 程度太強烈，以致無法忍受

Related form: **bearer**

A **bearer** is someone or something that carries, brings, holds, or transmits something.

bearer of news/message

Practice 50

> “I hate to be the **bearer of bad news**.”

「我很不想成為**帶來壞消息的人**。」

This is a very common expression.

disease bearer/carrier

More formal/older contexts can use **bearer** for someone carrying something such as a disease trait, though **carrier** is usually more standard medically.

bearer instrument

Finance/legal vocabulary includes terms such as:

* bearer bond

* bearer cheque

where possession of the document can determine entitlement under the relevant instrument.

Specialist use.

Related form: **bearing**

Bearing has become highly polysemous in its own right.

1. **bearing = direction/location relative to a reference point (導航) — 方位；方位角**

Practice 51

> “The ship changed its **bearing**.”

「船隻改變了**航向 / 方位**。」

This derives from **bear = move in a direction**.

2. **get one's bearings = establish where you are / understand the situation (固定表達)**

Literal:

> “I stopped to get my **bearings**.”

「我停下來確認自己的**方位**。」

Figurative:

> “Give me a minute to get my bearings.”

「給我一點時間**弄清楚情況 / 理清頭緒**。」

Very useful expression.

3. **bearing = manner/posture (舉止) — 儀態 ; 舉止**

> “She has a confident bearing.”

「她有很自信的**儀態 / 舉止**。」

Derived from **bear oneself**.

4. **have a bearing on = be relevant to/influence something (關係) — 對.....有關係 / 影響**

Practice 52

> “The evidence has a direct **bearing on** the case.”

「這項證據與案件有直接**關係 / 影響**。」

This family sense is common in formal English.

5. **bearing** = machine component supporting rotating parts (機械) — 軸承**

Practice 53

> “The wheel **bearing** needs replacing.”

「車輪**軸承**需要更換。」

This is a highly established technical noun and semantically specialized enough to learn separately.

Important distinction: **bear vs tolerate**

tolerate

= accept/endure something unpleasant.

bear

often sounds more emotional or personal:

> “I can’t bear the pain.”

Both work, but **can’t bear** is especially natural in everyday speech.

Important distinction: **bear vs endure**

endure

emphasizes continuing through prolonged difficulty.

bear

can mean endure, but also extends to costs, responsibilities, consequences, weight, etc.

> endure years of hardship

> bear the cost

Important distinction: ****bear vs carry****

****carry****

is the normal physical everyday verb.

****bear****

is more formal/literary and extends strongly into figurative uses.

- > carry a bag
- > bear a burden
- > bear responsibility

Important distinction: ****bear vs support****

For physical structures:

****support****

= hold something up.

****bear****

= carry the weight/load placed on it.

- > columns support the roof
- > columns bear the roof's weight

Very close, but the grammatical focus differs.

Important distinction: ****bear vs suffer****

****suffer****

emphasizes experiencing something bad.

****bear****

often emphasizes ****carrying/enduring**** that burden.

- > suffer losses
- > bear losses

Both are possible, but ****bear**** can imply who ultimately takes responsibility for the loss.

Important distinction: ****bear vs accept responsibility****

****accept responsibility****

explicitly means acknowledge responsibility.

****bear responsibility****

means have/carry that responsibility, whether or not the person willingly acknowledges it.

So they are not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: ****bear vs give birth****

****give birth to****

ordinary modern expression.

****bear a child****

more formal/literary.

- > She gave birth to a son.
- > She bore a son.

Same core event; very different register.

Grammar note: irregular forms

Form	Use	
-----	-----	
bear	base/present	
bears	third-person present	
bore	past	

****borne****	ordinary past participle
****born****	birth passive, especially ****be born****
****bearing****	-ing form

Examples:

- > She ****bore**** the cost.
- > The cost was ****borne**** by the company.
- > He was ****born**** in May.

Grammar note: ****can't bear + noun / -ing / to-infinitive****

All are common:

- > I can't bear the noise.
- > I can't bear waiting.
- > I can't bear to wait any longer.

The exact nuance varies slightly, but all express strong difficulty tolerating something.

Countability note

Animal / financial investor

Countable:

- > a bear
- > several bears

Verb senses

No countability issue.

Bearing

Different senses behave differently:

- > a bearing
- > several bearings
- > wheel bearings

Family-extension note

The practical family is unusually rich:

* **bear**
* **bears**
* **bore**
* **borne**
* **born**
* **bearing**
* **bearer**
* **bearable**
* **unbearable**
* **bearish**

Useful compounds/constructions include:

* bear the consequences
* bear the cost
* bear responsibility
* bear the burden
* bear fruit
* bear a child
* bear interest
* bear a signature
* bear resemblance
* bear witness
* bear left/right
* bear with someone
* bear in mind
* bear arms
* bear market
* bearer of bad news
* get one's bearings
* load-bearing
* interest-bearing

Some phrasal-verb branches such as **bear out**, **bear down**, and **bear on** exist, but I would keep them outside the bare-word core unless specifically targeted.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
bear — animal	熊

bear — carry physically	攜帶、搬運或負載某物；較正式	
bear — support weight	承受 / 支撐重量或負荷	
bear — tolerate/endure	忍受令人痛苦、不舒服或討厭的事情	
bear — cost/consequence/burden	承受 / 承擔成本、後果、風險、損失或負擔	
bear responsibility/blame	承擔責任 / 指責	
bear — plants	結出果實、花朵或農作物	
bear fruit — figurative	努力、計劃等產生實際成果	
bear — childbirth	生育 / 生下孩子；較正式	
bear — financial yield	資產、帳戶等產生利息 / 回報	
bear — mark/name/signature	帶有、載有、顯示名稱、標誌、簽名、痕跡等	
bear resemblance/relation	具有相似性 / 關係	
bear witness	作證；證實；成為某事的證據	
bear left/right	向左 / 右逐漸轉向或行進	
bear oneself	以某種姿態 / 舉止表現自己	
bear with someone	對某人有耐性；請稍候 / 包涵	
bear in mind	記住並在判斷時考慮	
bear — finance noun	預期價格下跌的投資者 / 空頭	
bear market	熊市；廣泛持續下跌的市場	
bearish	看淡 / 看跌的	
bearable / unbearable	可以忍受的 / 難以忍受的	
bearing — direction	方位 / 航向	
bearing — manner	儀態 / 舉止	
bearing — relevance	與某事的關係或影響	
bearing — machinery	軸承	

For your original sentence

> “Other patrons then ****bear the consequences****.”

The exact meaning is:

****bear** = 不是自己造成問題，卻必須承受這個問題所帶來的不利後果******

So:

> ****bear the consequences****

= ****承受後果 / 承擔後果****

The physical metaphor is still visible:

> ****carry a heavy load****

> → ****carry a difficult consequence****

For your database, I would count ****8 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****bear****:

1. ****noun: the animal****
2. ****physically carry or support weight****
3. ****endure/tolerate something unpleasant****
4. ****carry/accept a burden, cost, consequence, risk, or responsibility****
5. ****produce/yield — fruit, offspring, results, interest****
6. ****carry/display/possess a name, mark, resemblance, relation, sign, etc.****
7. ****move or turn in a particular direction****
8. ****finance noun: a market participant expecting prices to fall****

I would keep ****bear fruit, bear witness, bear with me, bear in mind, bear arms**** as high-value constructions, and treat ****bearing****, ****bearer****, ****bearable/unbearable****, and ****bearish**** as important family extensions rather than forcing their independent modern senses back into the base verb.